

Carousel overview

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RBA RATE GUIDE, SEPTEMBER 2026

RBA RATE RISE, 29 SEPTEMBER 2026

Rates are up again.
What it means for
Newcastle and Lake
Macquarie.

4.60%

The new cash rate, up 0.25 points. The fourth rise this year.

INSIDE, A PAGE FOR

Homeowners

First home buyers

Buyers and upgraders

Local prices

Sellers

Investors

General information only. Not financial advice.

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RBA RATE GUIDE, SEPTEMBER 2026

WHAT THE RBA DECIDED

The cash rate went from
4.35% to 4.60%

4.35 → 4.60

WHY THE BOARD MOVED

1 Inflation is still too high.
Underlying inflation hasn't come back to the 2 to 3% target.

2 Energy prices jumped.
Global energy prices are well above what the RBA assumed in August.

3 Businesses are passing on costs.
Firms told the RBA they are raising prices or plan to.

The cash rate isn't your loan rate.
Your lender decides how much to pass on and from what date. The Board also said it may raise rates further 'if needed'.

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RBA RATE GUIDE, SEPTEMBER 2026

FOR HOMEOWNERS

About \$91 a month more
on a \$600k loan

This rise All four 2026 rises

\$500k +\$76 / +\$303

\$600k +\$91 / +\$364

\$750k +\$114 / +\$454

\$1m +\$152 / +\$606

Extra monthly repayment if your lender passes rises on in full. Canstar estimates owner-occupier, principal and interest, 25 years left.

WHAT TO DO

1 Find your new repayment.
Check your lender's notice for the new rate and start date, then update your budget.

2 Ask for a better rate.
Before this rise, Canstar listed variable rates from 5.69% at some smaller lenders. Asking costs nothing.

3 Check when your fixed rate ends.
Rolling onto a variable rate could be a big jump. Plan for it now.

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RBA RATE GUIDE, SEPTEMBER 2026

FOR FIRST HOME BUYERS

Your borrowing power just
shrank

\$11,200 less for a single buyer on the average wage (\$108,650)

\$22,400 less for a couple on two average wages

Since January that's \$47,400 less for a single buyer and \$94,700 less for a couple. Both are down 9%.

Canstar estimates for a 30-year owner-occupier loan, no debts or dependants. Lenders test you at 3 points above your actual rate.

WHAT TO DO

1 Get your pre-approval re-checked.
One issued before this rise may now be too high. Reconfirm before you bid.

2 Leave room for one more rise.
ANZ expects another in November. Make sure you could carry it.

3 Ask about first home buyer support.
Deposit schemes and stamp duty concessions can make a real difference. Check what you qualify for.

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RBA RATE GUIDE, SEPTEMBER 2026

FOR BUYERS AND UPGRADERS

Fewer buyers to compete
with, but smaller budgets

Homes in Newcastle and Lake Macquarie now take a median 37 days to sell, up from 21 in April. You have more time and choice, but your borrowing power has shrunk too (see slide 4).

WHAT TO DO

1 Reconfirm your finance first.
Pre-approvals are based on the rate at the time. Have yours reassessed before you make offers.

2 Decide: sell first or buy first.
In a falling market, buying first risks carrying two loans while your old home sells for less.

3 Negotiate more than price.
Ask for longer settlements, or building and pest and finance clauses.

4 Watch two dates.
Inflation figures land on 28 October. The RBA decides again on 3 November.

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RBA RATE GUIDE, SEPTEMBER 2026

NEWCASTLE AND LAKE MACQUARIE

A strong year, then a soft
winter

8.1% house values over the 12 months to July

-3.0% house values over winter to a \$1.55m median

361 homes sold in August, down from 580 in October 2025

BIGGEST WINTER FALLS (over 3 months to July)

Hamilton -6.1%

Islington -5.8%

Wyee Point -5.7%

Dora Creek -5.6%

Georgetown -5.5%

Balcorn -5.4%

Hamilton East -5.4%

Blacksmiths -5.4%

Lambton -5.3%

Stockton -5.2%

ROSE OVER WINTER (over 3 months to July)

Elmore Vale +1.4%

New Lambton +1.0%

Redhead +0.8%

Toronto +0.4%

Morisset +0.3%

STRONGEST YEAR (over 3 months to July)

Eleebana +16.8%

Woodberry +16.4%

Teralba +16.1%

Whole region +8.1%

Top three suburbs Canstar reported for the region.

Redhead was the only house market in the region to rise.

Canstar's head of research, Gerard Burg, expects conditions to stay subdued this spring rather than rebound.

WHAT TO DO

1 Price on recent local sales.
Values fell in nearly every local suburb over winter. Last year's comparables may leave you sitting on the market.

2 Think about timing.
The next RBA decision is 3 November. Listing before then avoids a rise landing mid-campaign.

3 Plan for negotiation.
Homes are taking longer to sell, so buyers have room to push on price and terms.

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RBA RATE GUIDE, SEPTEMBER 2026

FOR SELLERS

Price for the market
you're actually in

Buyers can borrow less than they could in January, and they have more homes to choose from. Across Newcastle and Lake Macquarie, top-tier house values (over \$1.2 million) fell 3.1% over winter.

Canstar's head of research, Gerard Burg, expects conditions to stay subdued this spring rather than rebound.

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RBA RATE GUIDE, SEPTEMBER 2026

FOR INVESTORS

Rent resets slowly.
Repayments don't.

Rents stay put until your next lease review, so the gap between rent and repayments widens now. Locally, Newcastle-Maitland rents were a median \$722 a week in the three months to July, up 5.6% on a year earlier, with vacancy at 1.6%.

WHAT TO DO

1 Rerun the numbers on each property.
On interest-only loans the whole repayment is interest, so it rises by a bigger share.

2 Check fixed rates before you lock in.
Some lenders are lifting them. Canstar reports Macquarie raised fixed rates twice in three weeks.

3 Review rent at the next lease date.
Set it from nearby listings. A vacancy costs more than a modest increase earns.

4 Talk to your accountant.
Higher interest changes your tax position on investment loans.

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RBA RATE GUIDE, SEPTEMBER 2026

WHAT HAPPENS NEXT

Two dates to watch

28 Oct September quarter inflation figures come out

3 Nov Next RBA cash rate decision

The big four banks disagree. ANZ expects one more rise in November, to 4.85%. Before the decision, CBA, Westpac and NAB forecast September as the last rise this year.

Buying, selling or refinancing? Talk to Love.

[AGENT NAME] · [PHONE] · [WEBSITE OR BOOKING LINK]

Sources: RBA statement, 29 Sep 2026. Canstar, 28 and 29 Sep 2026. Canstar data via the Newcastle Herald, Aug and Sep 2026. This is general information and doesn't consider your circumstances. Speak to a licensed broker or adviser before you decide.

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9 slides
Portrait 4:5
1080 × 1350 px

Data as at
29 Sep 2026

06 Newcastle and Lake Macquarie

07 For sellers

08 For investors

09 What happens next

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Slide 01 Cover☐ Approved ☐ Changes needed

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Slide 02 What the RBA decided☐ Approved ☐ Changes needed



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Slide 03 For homeowners☐ Approved ☐ Changes needed

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Your borrowing power just shrank

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less for a couple on two average wages

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Deposit schemes and stamp duty concessions can make a real difference. Check what you qualify for.

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Slide 04 For first home buyers☐ Approved ☐ Changes needed

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NEWCASTLE AND LAKE MACQUARIE

A strong year, then a soft winter

+8.1%

house values over the 12 months to July

-3.0%

house values over winter, to a \$1.06m median

361

homes sold in August, down from 880 in October 2025

BIGGEST WINTER FALLS

Houses, 3 months to Aug

Hamilton	-6.1%
Islington	-5.8%
Wyee Point	-5.7%
Dora Creek	-5.6%
Georgetown	-5.5%
Balcolyn	-5.4%
Hamilton East	-5.4%
Blacksmiths	-5.4%
Lambton	-5.3%
Stockton	-5.2%

ROSE OVER WINTER

Units, 3 months to Aug

Elmore Vale	+1.4%
New Lambton	+1.0%
Redhead house	+0.8%
Toronto	+0.4%
Morisset	+0.3%

Redhead was the only house market in the region to rise.

STRONGEST YEAR

Houses, 12 months to Jul

Eleebana	+16.8%
Woodberry	+16.4%
Teralba	+16.1%
Whole region	+8.1%

Top three suburbs Cotality reported for the region.

Cotality data reported by the Newcastle Herald, 7 August, 1 September and 5 September 2026.

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Slide 06 Newcastle and Lake Macquarie☐ Approved ☐ Changes needed



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Cotality's head of research, Gerard Burg, expects conditions to stay subdued this spring rather than rebound.

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Slide 08 For investors☐ Approved ☐ Changes needed



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Slide 09 What happens next

☐ Approved ☐ Changes needed

Before posting

- ☐ Fill the contact card on slide 09: agent name, phone, website or booking link.
- ☐ Check that body text shows in Proxima Nova on the live canvas. This proof uses Montserrat as a stand-in.
- ☐ Post before 28 October. September quarter inflation figures land that day and the RBA decides again on 3 November.
- ☐ Share the canvas with the team from its Share menu.

Sources

RBA, Statement by the Monetary Policy Board, 29 September 2026

Canstar, repayment and borrowing power estimates, 28 and 29 September 2026

Cotality data reported by the Newcastle Herald, 7 and 19 August, 1, 2 and 5 September 2026

Final sign-off

Name, date